

ELIZABETHAN EXAGGERATION

Under Queen Elizabeth, the clothes worn by gallants grew more exaggerated. Ruffs, which first appeared in the 1560s, grew larger and larger, while hips and shoulders were padded to make the waist look narrow. Leg coverings often came in three sections – the round trunk hose at the top; the canions going to just below the knee; and the nether stockings worn underneath. The aim was to wear as many different fabrics and colors as possible.

Linen ruff stiffened with starch

A cartwheel ruff framed the face, making it look as if it were on a plate

Doublet with padded "peascod" belly

Trunk hose

Every gallant carried a sword

Canions

Nether stockings

A gallant of the 1590s, when smaller ruffs were back in fashion

A gallant of the 1580s, when ruffs were at their largest



Gallant's hat



Boy's hat

HATS OFF!

Men wore hats most of the time. Many gallants wore hats decorated with ostrich feathers, which they swept in front of them while bowing, as a greeting. In *Hamlet*, a gallant called Osric keeps waving his hat about. Hamlet says to him, "Put your bonnet to the right use; 'tis for the head."



FUNCTIONAL FASHION

Less wealthy men wore more practical versions of the clothes worn by gallants. They used cheaper fabrics such as wool instead of velvet or silk, and might have worn plain knee breeches rather than trunk hose and canions. They wore a ruff but did not worry if it was not the fashionable size.

THE RIGHT SHOES

This carved horn was used by a gallant in the 1590s to help him slip on his shoes. It is engraved with the image of a man of fashion. To a gallant, the right footwear was as important as the right ruff or doublet.

